



GDD 26 Equalize

Believe it, then live it

The equality-in-practice game for ages 12-15. A balancing-sim where teens spot the gap between believing in equality and living it, rebalance homes, classrooms and workplaces, and see that equality pays off, for everyone. It also faces child marriage as a rights issue. Seven mechanics, 29 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Believe it, then live it.

Where MythBuster: Gender (g25) proved stereotypes aren't facts, Equalize asks the harder, real-world question: if almost everyone says they believe in equality, why is the world still so unequal, in who does the unpaid work, who gets paid, who holds power? It's a balancing-sim: teens spot the gap between belief and practice and rebalance households, classrooms, workplaces and communities toward fairness. Its key insight, the one teens most need, is that equality is not zero-sum: fairness lifts everyone. It also faces child marriage, as a rights issue. New v2 build, deepening Fair Play World (g10).

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g26 · equalize (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 4 · ages 12-15 · real / evenhanded
Thread / topics	E · Gender & Respect · UNESCO 3.1, 3.2, 1.4, 2.2, 3.3, 4.1
Prerequisite / builds on	g25 (MythBuster: Gender) · builds on g10 (Fair Play World)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the equality balancing-sim.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

17

myth-flips

29

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

Equality pays off (not zero-sum). The teen insight at the core: reducing barriers benefits men too, and closing gaps could add trillions to GDP, up to a 35% rise in the most unequal countries. Women do around 60% more unpaid care work (worth ~9% of global GDP, yet invisible). So fairness isn't "men lose", it frees everyone: less pressure on boys, fairer homes, stronger economies.

The gap they live in.

From the Chapter 4 personas. Teens grow up in homes and schools that say "we're equal" while the practice often isn't; this game gives them the eyes to spot the gap and the moves to close it.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Veer, 14	To see equality frees him too, and to share the load.	strike-rewrite + branch : not zero-sum; pitch in.
Riya, 15	Fair pay/power, and protection of girls' education.	sort + branch : close the gaps.
Rohit (a dad)	To share the unpaid home load, by ability not gender.	branch + build : rebalance the home.
The Counsellor	To route a child-marriage risk to real help.	branch + role-play : report & support.
Every teen	To turn belief into everyday action.	branch + reflect : rebalance it.

Why this works (the evidence). Most people say they believe in equality, but practice lags: women do around 60% more unpaid household and care work, worth ~9% of global GDP yet invisible, which limits their pay and power. Equality is not zero-sum, reducing barriers benefits men too and closing gaps could add trillions to GDP. And child marriage is illegal in India (legal age 18 for girls, 21 for boys) and harmful, ending education and raising health risks; it's declining, and at-risk cases can reach Childline 1098.

Seven moves, led by the rebalance.

It's a balancing-sim, so **branch** leads (rebalance a home, class or workplace and see it respond), with **sort** spotting the belief-practice gap and **strike-rewrite** flipping the "zero-sum" and child-marriage myths. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE TEEN DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (rebalance) signature	Rebalances a system toward fairness and sees the payoff.	Systems; consequence.	23
strike-rewrite	Flips a myth ("equality = men lose"; "child marriage is fine").	Conceptual change.	17
sort	Sorts belief vs practice; fair vs biased; fact vs myth.	Spot the gap.	15
reflect	Considers their own gaps and equality's personal payoff.	Self-application.	12
match	Pairs a gap to its fix; a leader to her field.	Solutions.	6
role-play (voice)	Proposes fair sharing; supports a girl at risk.	Voice; allyship.	6
build	Builds a fair rota, a rebalance plan, the 'pays-off' summary.	The system, by hand.	5

29 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Equalize plays like a satisfying balancing puzzle: a home, class or workplace tilts unfairly, the mum doing every chore, only boys presenting, and you redistribute the load until it balances and visibly thrives. The "watch it get better when you make it fair" feedback, plus the genuinely surprising "equality pays off for everyone" reveal, makes a structural topic feel hands-on and hopeful.

Is it teaching?

Yes, equality as lived practice: that belief must become action, that the unpaid load and the pay/power gaps are real and fixable, that equality is win-win not zero-sum, and that child marriage is a harmful, illegal rights violation a young person can help prevent.

The belief it moves. From "we already have equality; if women win, men lose; men get nothing from it; child marriage is just tradition" → "belief must become practice; equality is win-win and frees boys too; the unpaid load and gaps are fixable; and every child deserves to grow up and learn first."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the gap → unpaid load → pay/power → pays-off → child marriage → rebalance arc, evidence-based and India-grounded. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Belief vs practice	14	sort, branch, reflect	The gap between saying and living equality; spot & close it.
The unpaid load	13	branch, sort, build	The 'second shift'; sharing chores and care by ability.
Pay & power	12	sort, match, strike-rewrite	Pay gap, leadership gap; equal pay, fair hiring, mentoring.
Equality pays off	16	strike-rewrite, match, branch	Not zero-sum; men gain; economy gains; fairer families.
Child marriage	16	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	Harmful & illegal; ends education; report to Childline 1098.
Rebalance it	13	branch, role-play, build	Everyday rebalancing; share, back others, call it out.

A rebalance branch + the not-zero-sum flip, verbatim.

branch: "At home, the cooking, cleaning and care all fall on the women. Rebalance it."
 best -> "Share the tasks across everyone, by ability not gender" (the load lightens and it's fa

flip: "Equality is a fight where if women win, men lose."
 UN -> "Gender equality is zero-sum; if women win, men lose."
 RE -> "Equality isn't zero-sum; reducing barriers benefits men too."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 26 Equalize — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
We already have equality; nothing left to do.	Belief moved faster than practice; real gaps remain.	Belief-action gap.
If women win, men lose.	Equality isn't zero-sum; reducing barriers benefits men too.	Economics.
Men get nothing out of equality.	Men gain freedom, closer relationships and far less pressure.	Men gain.
Women earn less because they choose easier work.	Much of the gap is bias and the unpaid-care load.	Pay gap.
A man who shares housework is weak.	Sharing the load builds respect and a happier home.	Masculinity.
Marrying girls young is just tradition, so it's fine.	Child marriage is harmful and illegal; girls should grow up first.	Child marriage law.
Girls who'll marry don't need to finish school.	Every girl deserves a full education and her own future.	Education / rights.
If a child marriage is planned, nothing can stop it.	It can be reported and prevented, via Childline 1098.	Safeguarding.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "everyone says it's equal here, is it, really?".
2. **Play.** Spot the gap (sort), rebalance a system (branch), or flip a myth, rotated.
3. **It rebalances.** A fairer setup visibly thrives; the debrief shows the shared payoff.
4. **The flip.** On a myth, UN strikes it and RE writes the truth ("men lose" → everyone gains).
5. **Rights & safety.** Child-marriage scenarios route to a trusted adult and Childline 1098, never blame.
6. **Sticker.** The Equalizer badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **balancing-sim board**, tilt a system fair and watch it thrive, plus the **myth-flip card**. The economics and not-zero-sum framing carry into the adult gender nodes (g50 Equal & Confident); the child-marriage safeguarding links to Childline.

Evenhanded, India-real, safe.

- **Register.** Ages 12-15, real and evenhanded; equality is shown as everyone's win, not a contest.
- **Not zero-sum.** Boys' gains are made explicit (less pressure, more freedom), so no one feels attacked.
- **Action over slogans.** The game rewards changing what people do, not just what they say.
- **Child marriage as rights, handled with care.** Framed as harmful and illegal, never graphic; never the girl's fault; respectful of culture while clear it's wrong.
- **Route to help.** Child-marriage risk routes to a trusted adult and Childline 1098 / 112.
- **Access.** Audio-first, offline; India-grounded (unpaid care, the law, women leaders); builds on Fair Play World (g10).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. equalize** — `node.game === GameDone key === registry id` (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. `type + typed payload`; the **branch** balancing-sim leads, with **sort** for the gap and **strike-rewrite** for the myths.
- **Fact-checked content**. Unpaid-care and not-zero-sum economics, and the India child-marriage law, verified; flag legal/economic edits for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, branch at 27%, 0% binary, 29 autonomy, 17 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook**. Child-marriage routing via the shared "get help" component (trusted adult / Childline 1098).
- **Tracked**. `sync_master_tracker.py` marks g26 v2 PASS in the Master Node Table.
- **Generated path**. Label/order/thread changes flow through the `xlsx + gen-path`, never hand-edited `path.ts`.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): action over slogans; equality is everyone's win; child marriage framed as rights, never blame; route risk to help; evenhanded; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **The belief-practice gap is the real problem.** Because almost everyone now says they believe in equality while the unpaid load and pay/power gaps persist, the game targets practice, the balancing-sim makes the invisible work visible and fixable.
- **'Not zero-sum' is the mind-changer.** Since the biggest block among teens (and boys especially) is "equality means men lose", leading with the evidence that fairness lifts everyone is what actually opens minds.
- **Child marriage is preventable, and youth can help.** Framing it as harmful, illegal and reportable (Childline 1098), never the girl's fault, turns a heavy topic into agency, and protecting girls' education is the proven lever.

Sources: IMF / UN Women on the economics of gender equality (not zero-sum; unpaid care ~9% of GDP; trillions in potential gains); Government of India Prohibition of Child Marriage Act (legal age 18/21) and Childline 1098.

Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 30 games now v2. Next in Chapter 4: Stand Up (g27).